supplies the world market with textile fabrics cannot find enough to cover his own and his children's bodies; the masons, smiths and carpenters who rear magnificent palaces, live and perish in slums'. No ruling government could have sat idly by to hear of 'the capitalist exploiters, the parasites of Society squander millions on their whims' that such utterances railed against. Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt took them to task as they directly questioned '[t]hese terrible inequalities, and forced disparity of chances' which they believed was inevitably 'heading towards chaos'.

With these words, these young students challenged the British Raj, in a way in which Gandhi and the Congress Party refused to do. This is what made them so dangerous to the Raj. Faced with this, the response of the authorities was not to engage with them, but to dismiss them as lunatics and fanatics. This allowed them to delete the ideological basis of the couple's attack on the Delhi Legislative Assembly. This is why to this day these statements by Bhagat Singh and B.K.Dutt, which espoused the very essence of their revolutionary philosophy, lie forgotten in India. It served the interests of the imperial government to dismiss these two disparagingly as deranged with the result that they 'were being wrongly ascribed the status of madmen and fanatics'.[14] Yet, this was an old colonial habit, one of maligning insurgents as 'lunatics', and it is one which still exists in the political culture of the region today, but which back then was deliberately designed to camouflage the exercise of unsparing, unadorned and unvarnished oppressive state power under the ruse of the rule of law.

This is why, as long ago as 1867, the Government of India had passed what Mark Condos describes as 'one of the most brutal-minded and draconian laws ever created in colonial India', and this was the Murderous Outrages Act. Although it was originally designed to deal with 'fanatics' in the North-West Frontier, it was far from peripheral in its impact, and Condos has shown how 'this law both drew upon and enabled a wider legal culture that pervaded India in the wake of 1857' and in the end worked 'to mask the brute power of executive authority through legalistic terms'.[15] This is why, in the words of Neeti Nair, as soon as the trial started, the government proceeded with 'labelling these revolutionaries "murderers"